

THE SCIENCE OF SNOBBERY

Research can suggest that you don't actually enjoy wine, classical music, or even fancy foods. But the snobs aren't making it all up. Some research suggests that those judging classical music judged the competition based on visual information just as amateurs do. So is there any truth to it? Read on to find out: <http://dgit.in/wwsnoby>

THE PHONE THAT WON'T DIE

The Nokia 3310's virtual indestructibility has made it a legend—or at least the subject of countless internet memes. It has been thrown, smashed, run over, shot and even set on fire. The New Yorker has its own tribute: <http://dgit.in/3310ftw>

TAKE BACK THE INTERNET!

"The US government has betrayed the internet. We need to take it back," says Bruce Schneier. The NSA has undermined a fundamental social contract and he believes engineers who built the internet now have a moral responsibility to fix it? For more of his suggestions read his article on The Guardian: <http://dgit.in/wwiback>

THE STRANGE STORY OF SKYPE

What if people could transfer their words, like a telephone, without a phone and the bills? That's probably what someone, somewhere thought, and thus was born Skype. As the service turned 10 recently, Ars Technica takes a look back at how six Europeans changed the world. Follow the link to find out more: <http://dgit.in/wwskype>

The iPhone 5S: What we don't like

Yes we're not fanboys. The iPhone 5S isn't all awesome, obviously. Here we present some of things that left us wanting more.

- By Sameer Mitha

When Apple announced the much-anticipated iPhone 5S to the world last month most agreed the device is everything the rumour mills said it would be. In terms of its looks the device shares its dimensions with last year's iPhone 5. The improvements or rather the changes to the smartphone come under the hood with the processor, camera performance, the ability to recognize your finger-print and more.

Even though there are some features that we liked and listed on the page alongside there are some features that we didn't. Here is a look at some of the features that failed to impress us.

The camera: We are now in the era of Ultrapixels and noticeably large sensors creeping into flagship cameras, but we have here the iPhone 5S with no resolution bump, which the company justifies as a trade-off of increasing sensor area and pixel pitch. The HTC One has bigger pixel pitch (2 microns vs. 1.5 microns on the iPhone 5S) and the Sony Xperia Z1 has a larger sensor (1/2.3"). We're not even going to drag the Nokia Lumia 1020 into this comparison as that would be like bringing out a howitzer to a gun fight. The aperture of f/2.2 is also not very impressive when compared with other flagships such as the Sony Xperia Z1 (f/2.0) and the HTC One (f/2.0). Lastly, the lack of optical image stabilization is rather disappointing. The camera feels like an incremental bump from its predecessor when Apple really needed a game changer. Imaging is becoming really important in the mobile field and while the bundled



camera is good, it might just be falling behind over time.

No NFC: It's taken for granted that if you have a premium smartphone, it will support NFC. Check again, the iPhone 5S still doesn't support NFC. NFC can be used to make payments (Google Wallet is a good example of that), data transfer (touching two NFC enabled smartphones to transfer data), and even to wirelessly charge some smartphones. There are a lot of accessory makers that make NFC enabled accessories for smartphones, the most popular among them being speakers. If you want to wirelessly play music from your iPhone, you will need an AirPlay enabled speaker. Why can't Apple just go mainstream and adopt NFC? Or will it be the next big feature in the iPhone 6? Bumping two devices to transfer data is not as uncool as Apple would like you to think.

Not weatherproof: Sony wasn't even in the top three of our recommendations list when it came to Android smartphones. That has changed ever since the launch of the Xperia Z series of devices. Not only are they well-built but they're also weather-proof. We have put this claim to the test and we are happy to say that if you are clumsy enough to take your smartphone in the shower with you, you need to own the Sony Xperia Z. There are a number of smartphones available that boast of dust and waterproof capabilities and even though the iPhone 5S is a well-built smartphone, one splash of water and the device will be rendered useless. Sure, there are third party cases available to protect the smartphone but being really sturdy and above all weather proof is something we hoped the device would be straight out of the box.

Same 4-inch display: The iPhone 5S has a 4-inch Retina Display with an 1136x640 pixel resolution giving it a pixel density of 326PPI. We have seen a lot of smartphones launch in the market such as the Galaxy S4, Xperia Z1, Xperia Z, LG Optimus G2 and more that have crossed the 400PPI pixel density mark. Even though the display of the iPhone looks good, it is really small when compared to the competition.

Screen size: Apple is still stubbornly sticking to the maxim that "4-inches is the ideal size". It would be so much better if Apple could just jump off its high horse for just a minute and realise that people are asking, nay, clamouring for phones with larger screens.

<http://dgit.in/1d7biba>